2026/2027
Forsyth County Schools — Denmark High School
High School Course Syllabus (CTAE)

Legal Environment of Business

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Updated July 2026

TEACHER INFORMATION

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Availability for Extra Help: [Available for extra help before/after school — insert times]. Meetings are by appointment only, and I am willing to meet outside of these hours with plenty of notice.

COURSE INFORMATION

Course Description:

Legal Environment of Business addresses statutes and regulations affecting businesses, families, and individuals. All students will benefit with the knowledge of business law as they will eventually assume roles as citizens, workers, and consumers in their communities and in society at large.

Students will get an overview of business law while concentrating on the legal aspects of business ownership and management. Legal issues addressed include court procedures, contracts, torts, consumer law, employment law, environmental law, international law, ethics, and the role of the government in business. Students will not only understand the concepts, but will also apply their knowledge to situations and defend their actions, decisions, and choices.

Various forms of technologies will be highlighted to expose students to the emerging technologies impacting the business world. Professional communication skills and practices, problem-solving, ethical and legal issues, and the impact of effective presentation skills are expanded in this course to prepare students to be college and career ready. Employability skills are integrated into activities, tasks, and projects throughout this course to demonstrate skills required by business and industry. Competencies in the co-curricular student organization, Future Business Leaders of America (FBLA), are integral components of both the employability skills and content standards of this course.

Course Standards:

GADOE — 06.41500 — Legal Environment of Business, Georgia CTAE Course Standards (BMA-LEB) (link)

Materials Needed:

Students use a school-issued Chromebook for all coursework. A folder or binder (physical or digital) for case study notes, case briefs, and the daily journal/portfolio is recommended. No purchased textbook is required.

Classroom Standards Handbook:

This course is also governed by a separate Business Education Classroom Standards Handbook, distributed and signed at the start of the year. It provides full classroom-level detail on device/cell phone use, due dates and late work, academic integrity, AI use, professional conduct, classroom visitors, and food & drink. Where a topic is addressed in both documents (academic integrity, device/cell phone policy, and late work), this syllabus reflects the handbook's policy.

Access this course in Canvas for the most up-to-date course information, including ancillary materials and key dates.

PROJECTED COURSE TIMELINE

The table below reflects the district-approved 2026–27 unit sequence and daily pacing plan (S1 and S2 Pacing Planners), which builds on the CTAERN project-based pacing guide and integrates 16 free, real-world business law case studies (see Case Study Library below) into the units where they align to Georgia standards. This course is scheduled in two instructional terms: Semester 1 (Aug 6 – Dec 18, 2026) and Semester 2 (Jan 5 – May 27, 2027). Exact dates may shift slightly to accommodate the school calendar, but unit order, major assignments, and embedded case studies will remain consistent.

Semester 1 (Aug 6 – Dec 18, 2026)

Unit	Approx. Timeline	Major Assignments / Assessments	Case Studies Used
Orientation	Aug 6 – 7	Syllabus & grading overview FBLA introduction Legal vocabulary pre-assessment	—
Unit 1 — Ethics, Employability & Sources of Law	Aug 10 – Sep 1	Ethical Dilemma written argument Employability Skills Workshop Unethical Conduct Consequence Analysis Unit 1 Glossary Quiz	Enron Securities Class Action (2006) Martha Stewart Insider Trading (2004) Bastiat, "The Law" — Socratic reading/debate
Unit 2 — The Court System & Dispute Resolution	Sep 2 – Oct 7	Court System Diagram Mock Civil Trial (summative) Legal Dispute Case Study paper Unit 2 Glossary Quiz	Dow Corning Breast Implant Litigation (1998) WorldCom Securities Class Action (2005)
Unit 3 — Business Crimes	Oct 8 – 22	White-Collar Crime infographic Cybercrime Evidence Board Project (summative) Unit 3 Glossary Quiz	Martha Stewart Insider Trading — criminal law revisit Enron — business crime elements revisit
Unit 4 — Tort Law	Oct 23 – Nov 9	Reasonable Person Scenario Analysis Business Tort Scenario Workshop (summative) Unit 4 Glossary Quiz	★ Liebeck v. McDonald's Hot Coffee (1994) — anchor case Exxon Shipping Co. v. Baker (2008)
Unit 5 — Contract Law	Nov 10 – Dec 4	Draft Your Own Contract (summative) Contract Breach Case Study analysis Unit 5 Glossary Quiz	Tobacco Master Settlement Agreement (1998)
Unit 6 — Business Structures & Formation	Dec 7 – 14	Business Structure Comparison Chart USPTO trademark database activity	—
Semester 1 Review & Exam	Dec 15 – 18	Comprehensive review — case study carousel (Units 1–6) Semester 1 Final Exam	Revisits Units 1–5 case studies

No school (per the FCS district calendar) within this window: Labor Day (Sep 7) • Fall Break (Sep 28 – Oct 2) • Thanksgiving Break (Nov 23 – 27) • Winter Break begins after Dec 18 and runs through Jan 4; students return Jan 5.

Semester 2 (Jan 5 – May 27, 2027)

Unit	Approx. Timeline	Major Assignments / Assessments	Case Studies Used
Unit 7 — Statutory & Regulatory Schemes	Jan 5 – Feb 11	Bankruptcy case studies IP Infringement Analysis Consumer Rights Research Project (summative) Environmental Law Case Analysis Unit 7 Glossary Quiz	Dow Corning — Ch. 11 Bankruptcy revisit Kashi "All Natural" GMO Labeling Class Action Exxon Valdez — environmental law revisit TCPA — American Eagle Outfitters IKEA Age Discrimination (ADEA anchor) Sambucks vs. Starbucks (trademark) Apple vs. Qualcomm (patent)
Unit 8 — Employment & Labor Law	Feb 17 – Mar 19	EEOC Complaint Simulation Employment Law Compliance Plan (summative) Unit 8 Glossary Quiz	Builds on IKEA/ADEA case from Unit 7
Unit 9 — E-Commerce & Technology Law	Mar 22 – Apr 14	E-Commerce Compliance Plan (summative) Unit 9 Glossary Quiz	Snap Inc. BIPA Biometric Privacy Class Action (2022)
Unit 10 — International Business Law & Culture	Apr 15 – May 7	International Business Transaction Project (summative) Unit 10 Glossary Quiz	—
Unit 11 — FBLA & Career Development	May 10 – 21	FBLA Opportunity Research Business-Education Partnership Proposal (summative)	—
Semester 2 Review & Exam	May 24 – 27	Comprehensive review — case study carousel (Units 7–11) Semester 2 Final Exam	Revisits Units 7–9 case studies

No school (per the FCS district calendar) within this window: MLK Day (Jan 18) • Presidents' Week (Feb 12 – 16) • Spring Break (Apr 5 – 9).

Final Exam Exemption: Students may exempt the final exam if they have a 90 or above course average.

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CASE STUDY LIBRARY

This course is built around 16 free, real-world business law case studies drawn from publicly available court opinions, SEC records, and news sources (no cost to students or families). Several cases are intentionally revisited across units so students gain depth by analyzing the same facts through a new legal lens — for example, Dow Corning appears first as a class action in Unit 2 and again as a Chapter 11 bankruptcy in Unit 7.

Unit	Case Study	Legal Concept	Standards
Unit 1	Enron Securities Class Action (2006)	White-collar crime / ethics	BMA-LEB-2.1, 2.4, 2.5
Unit 1	Martha Stewart Insider Trading (2004)	Business ethics	BMA-LEB-2.1, 2.4, 2.5
Unit 2	Dow Corning Breast Implant Litigation (1998)	Class action / civil suit process	BMA-LEB-3.4, 3.5, 3.7, 3.8
Unit 2	WorldCom Securities Class Action (2005)	Class action mechanics	BMA-LEB-3.4, 3.5, 3.7, 3.8
Unit 3	Martha Stewart Insider Trading — criminal revisit	White-collar crime elements	BMA-LEB-4.1, 4.2, 4.3
Unit 3	Enron — business crime elements revisit	Fraud / conspiracy / money laundering	BMA-LEB-4.1, 4.2, 4.3
Unit 4	★ Liebeck v. McDonald's Hot Coffee (1994)	Negligence (anchor case)	BMA-LEB-5.1–5.5
Unit 4	Exxon Shipping Co. v. Baker (2008)	Strict liability / punitive damages	BMA-LEB-5.1–5.5
Unit 5	Tobacco Master Settlement Agreement (1998)	Contract formation / breach remedies	BMA-LEB-6.1, 6.5, 6.8
Unit 7	Dow Corning Bankruptcy (1998) — Ch. 11 revisit	Chapter 11 reorganization	BMA-LEB-7.1, 7.3, 7.4
Unit 7	Kashi "All Natural" GMO Labeling (2014–2016)	Consumer protection / false advertising	BMA-LEB-7.1, 7.3, 7.4
Unit 7	Exxon Valdez — environmental law revisit	Environmental law	BMA-LEB-7.1, 7.3, 7.4
Unit 7	TCPA — American Eagle Outfitters (2016)	Consumer privacy / text spam	BMA-LEB-7.1, 7.3, 7.4
Unit 7	IKEA Age Discrimination (2019)	ADEA / employment discrimination (anchor)	BMA-LEB-7.5, 7.6
Unit 7	Sambucks vs. Starbucks (2005)	Trademark infringement	BMA-LEB-7.2
Unit 7	Apple vs. Qualcomm (2017–2019)	Patent infringement / royalties	BMA-LEB-7.2
Unit 9	Snap Inc. BIPA Class Action (2022)	Biometric / consumer data privacy	BMA-LEB-8.1, 8.2, 8.3

Teaching notes: The "hide the facts, then reveal" strategy is used with the Liebeck v. McDonald's anchor case to build critical thinking before students learn the full facts. Students use a consistent case brief format (Parties | Facts | Issue | Rule | Analysis | Conclusion) for written case analyses. Case study deep-dives are generally scheduled on 95-minute block days.

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DAILY JOURNAL & DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

Each class period begins with a brief written journal prompt (5–7 minutes) connecting the day's legal topic to students' own lives, future careers, or a current business scenario. Journals are stamped periodically for participation and reviewed each semester. Students also maintain a running portfolio of major case studies, projects, and reflections, which is referenced at the end of each semester (including a course-reflection and "letter to next year's LEB student" during Semester 2 exam week).

EMPLOYABILITY SKILLS: STANDARD 1

Standard 1 across all CTAE courses focuses on demonstrating the employability skills valued by business and industry. This encompasses effective communication, creativity, critical thinking, and problem-solving abilities. It also involves displaying work readiness traits essential for workplace success and using the necessary skills to contribute productively on the job. Additionally, Standard 1 highlights the importance of maintaining a professional image through appropriate appearance, behavior, and language. In this course, employability skills are woven throughout every unit and anchored by a dedicated Unit 11 (FBLA & Career Development).

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CAREER TECHNICAL STUDENT ORGANIZATION (CTSO)

Career Technical Student Organizations (CTSOs) are co-curricular organizations with leadership programs and competitive events which reflect current curriculum standards and competencies for the instructional programs they serve. Teachers infuse CTSO activities into instructional activities, helping students see the real-world value of their academic studies. The CTSO for this course appears below, and students are encouraged to take advantage of these additional leadership opportunities.

FBLA: The mission of Georgia FBLA is to bring business and education together in a positive working relationship through innovative leadership and career development programs. This course includes a dedicated FBLA & Career Development unit in which students research competitive events related to business law and design a business-education partnership proposal.

DRESS FOR SUCCESS

Career and technical education pathways in Forsyth County incorporate Dress for Success Days throughout the school year. These experiences allow students to foster confidence and continue to develop a positive self-image, while understanding the importance of dressing well for their future profession. At certain intervals throughout the course, students will analyze industry standards of the profession and study the importance of dressing well for a job interview. This will culminate in being fully prepared for Community Mock Interviews which occur as students complete a career pathway.

END OF PATHWAY ASSESSMENT / CREDENTIALS OF VALUE

Students are encouraged to choose a career pathway in 9th or 10th grade that aligns with their college and career goals. This course may be part of a three-course CTAE pathway sequence that concludes with a nationally recognized online industry credentialing assessment. This exam allows students to demonstrate the skills they've learned and may lead to earning an FCS Pathway Medallion and State Career Pathway Diploma Seals upon graduation. Student directory information may be shared with credentialing vendors offering the assessment. The technical coursework completed throughout the pathway provides the foundation needed for success on the exam, and teachers will share testing details, study guides, and other resources to support student preparation.

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ASSESSMENT & GRADING

Assessment Categories:

- Formative Assessments include, but are not limited to, homework, class work, glossary quizzes, BusinessU lesson quizzes, case brief drafts, and sections of projects/case studies/presentations.
- Summative Assessments include, but are not limited to, unit projects (e.g., Mock Civil Trial, Cybercrime Evidence Board, Draft Your Own Contract, Employment Law Compliance Plan, E-Commerce Compliance Plan), unit tests, final exams, and case study analysis papers.

Grading Scale	Grading Weights	Grading Calculations
A = 90–100 B = 80–89 C = 70–79 F = 0–69	Formative = 25% + Summative = 75% (midterm and final exam multiplier = 1)	50% (Semester 1) + 50% (Semester 2) = Course Average

Make-up Work (Excused Absence):

Make-up work is defined as work assigned during a student's absence, not work assigned prior to an absence. Students who are absent from school have five (5) school days upon returning to school to complete makeup work. The teacher has discretion to grant a longer period of time to make up the work if there are extenuating circumstances.

Due Dates & Late Work (Classroom Standards Handbook):

Outside of excused-absence makeup above, this class follows the late work schedule from the Business Education Classroom Standards Handbook, distributed and signed separately at the start of the year:

Timing	Credit
On time	Full earned credit
Up to 1 week late	89% of earned credit
1–2 weeks late	80% of earned credit
More than 2 weeks late	May not be accepted; see teacher

Late work is submitted using the "Late Assignment Submission Form" in the Class Resources module on Canvas. Illness, family emergencies, school-sponsored events, and similar extenuating circumstances may qualify for a waived or reduced penalty if communicated before the deadline or as soon as reasonably possible after; documentation may be requested.

Summative Reassessment:

Summative assessments identify standards where students demonstrate or lack proficiency. Educators use assessment evidence to accurately report levels of student proficiency in a grade-level subject or course and guide next steps. To support continued learning, students may engage in one summative reassessment opportunity per semester per course.

Procedures:

- All formative assessments must be complete before a student takes a corresponding summative reassessment.
- The student must engage in re-teaching activities prior to the summative reassessment.

- The teacher collaborative team can determine one of two methods for reassessment: engage the student in re-teaching activities and reassess the standards, or engage the student in re-teaching activities and use the midterm or final exam to reassess the aligned standards.
- To ensure accuracy in grading and reporting practices, full credit is applied to all reassessments.
- When a student does not show minimal proficiency of standards on multiple summative assessments, a multi-tiered system of supports will be put in place to assist the student in reaching proficiency.

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ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

It is the expectation of Forsyth County Schools that students exhibit academic integrity when submitting evidence of learning. When students submit evidence that does not authentically represent what they know and can do, the evidence is rendered invalid. Examples of academic dishonesty are outlined in the Family Engagement Guide & Student Handbook, the Forsyth County Schools Code of Conduct, and this classroom's Business Education Classroom Standards Handbook (distributed and signed separately). The classroom-level definitions and consequences below are aligned with that handbook.

What Counts as Cheating:

- Copying another student's work and submitting it as your own.
- Submitting work from websites, previous students, case study source material, or any outside source without attribution.
- Allowing another student to copy your work — you are equally responsible.
- Failing to cite sources, references, or acknowledge help you received.
- Sharing assignments with peers who will submit similar or identical work.
- Using AI tools in contexts where they are prohibited, or failing to disclose permitted AI use (see the classroom's AI Use Policy).

What Is Allowed:

- Collaborating with peers to understand concepts.
- Using Canvas materials, primary legal sources (court opinions, SEC filings), documentation, and course resources.
- Asking the teacher for help — always.
- Using approved AI tools within the boundaries described in the classroom AI Use Policy, with disclosure.
- Crediting a peer who helped you understand something.

Consequences for High School Students:

Offense	Consequence
First Offense	Parent contact + academic integrity contract + take a different assessment with a maximum assessment score of up to 60%
Second Offense	Parent contact + loss of credit up to 100% + removal from honor clubs/societies + possible in-school suspension or out-of-school suspension
Third Offense	Parent conference + loss of credit up to 100% + possible out-of-school suspension

- Academic Integrity offenses will not reset each school year. For example: If a student has an academic integrity offense during 9th grade and another one in 10th grade, the offense in 10th grade would be considered their second overall offense.
- Standardized Assessments: Any suspicion or instances of cheating on standardized tests will be reported to the governing agency and, based on the severity of the behavior, will receive disciplinary consequences.
- Severe Offenses: Should a student engage in behavior that compromises the integrity of an assessment (i.e., theft of assessment, pictures/dissemination of content, etc.), immediate and more severe consequences (up to a disciplinary tribunal) may be applied.

**Students who face consequences for submitting work that does not reflect their own knowledge and skills may only reassess in accordance with the Academic Integrity Consequences outlined above.*

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RESPONSIBLE USE OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

Artificial Intelligence refers to computer systems that are trained with data to accomplish tasks normally requiring human intelligence. AI is used across industries and communities and can serve as a helpful tool in educational settings. Students should learn how to evaluate if and when they should use AI and develop responsible and ethical practices when using AI tools. Students within Forsyth County Schools are expected to uphold the highest standards of academic integrity. This includes the responsible use of emerging technologies such as artificial intelligence.

Students will:

- Use approved age-appropriate AI tools for educational purposes only
- Follow teacher guidance on the use of AI tools
- Submit work that is fundamentally their own and provide proper citations when AI is used
- Evaluate the purpose, safety, and the trustworthiness of AI tools before use
- Review and critically assess output of AI tools recognizing that AI may contain bias and inaccuracies
- Not use AI tools to propagate harmful, misleading, offensive or inappropriate content

All members of Forsyth County Schools' community agree to follow the Forsyth County Schools Code of Conduct, school rules and commit to these responsible use guidelines.

Classroom-specific AI boundaries and disclosure requirements for this course are provided in the Business Education Classroom Standards Handbook.

FCS HIGH SCHOOL DISTRACTION-FREE LEARNING INFORMATION

FCS High School Cell Phone/Electronic Device Contract: In alignment with GA HB340, the Distraction-Free Education Act, which mandates that local school systems establish policies governing personal electronic device use for students in kindergarten through eighth grade, Forsyth County Schools has extended these restrictions to include high school students. Under this policy, high school students' personal electronic devices must remain secured and out of sight from 8:25 AM until the end of the school day at 3:40 PM, except for permitted use during lunch periods.

“Personal electronic device” means any portable electronic device capable of transmitting, receiving, or accessing communications, data, or media. This term includes, but is not limited to, personal laptops and headphones, smartphones, smartwatches, tablets, e-readers, smart glasses, and other devices with functionalities such as wireless communication, internet access, messaging, video recording, gaming, social media access, or data transmission.

Classroom Device Policy (Classroom Standards Handbook):

- Students use school-issued Chromebooks for all coursework; personal laptops and tablets are not permitted in this class.
- Cell phones are prohibited during the school day per school policy and are strictly enforced in this classroom — phones must be stored out of sight, not on the desk or in hand.
- Devices are closed or screen-down during direct instruction unless students are directed to use them; during work time, devices are open for course-related tasks only.
- Earbuds/headphones are not permitted unless explicitly approved for a specific activity.
- Full consequences for device and cell phone violations are outlined in the Business Education Classroom Standards Handbook, distributed and signed separately at the start of the year.

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INSTRUCTIONAL RESOURCES AND ACCESS

All learning resources, both print and digital, are meant to support and enhance the student learning experience in this class. This year's course draws primarily on Business U (lesson texts and platform quizzes) for core legal content, supplemented by teacher-built glossary quizzes and free, publicly available primary and secondary legal sources (court opinions, SEC records, and government agency materials) used to teach the embedded case studies. Below are the names of the platforms and websites used in this course. Some web-based resources require parent permission per federal regulations. Federal laws that guide parent permission requirements are as follows:

- **Children's Internet Protection Act (CIPA):** The school is required by CIPA to have technology measures and policies in place that protect students from harmful materials, including those that are obscene and pornographic. Any harmful content contained within inappropriate sites will be blocked. http://fcc.gov/cgb/consumerfacts/cipa.html
- **Children's Online Privacy Protection Act (COPPA):** COPPA applies to commercial companies and limits their ability to collect personal information from children under 13 years of age. No personal student information is collected for commercial purposes. https://www.ftc.gov/tips-advice/business-center/guidance/complying-coppa-frequently-asked-questions-0
- **Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA):** FERPA protects the privacy of student education records and gives parents the right to review records. Under FERPA, schools may disclose directory information in certain circumstances. http://www2.ed.gov/policy/gen/guid/fpco/ferpa

Please review the resources below. Each website related to the curriculum resources is provided along with its privacy policy. Should you have any questions regarding these resources, immediately contact the course teacher via email or phone.

Name of Resource*	Hard Copy/Website	Privacy Policy
Business U	https://cte.stukent.com/business	https://www.stukent.com/privacypolicy/
Canvas (LMS)	https://www.instructure.com/canvas	https://www.instructure.com/policies/privacy
Pathful	https://www.virtualjobshadow.com/login/	https://www.virtualjobshadow.com/resources/policy/
Canva	https://www.canva.com	https://www.canva.com/policies/privacy-policy/
Google Edu Workspace	https://edu.google.com	https://policies.google.com/privacy

** The above resources are county approved. These resources may vary by school due to sequencing, pacing, curriculum design, and/or individual needs of students.*

Name of Resource**	Website	Privacy Policy
NOCTI	https://www.nocti.com	https://www.nocti.org/privacy-policy/
Kahoot	https://www.kahoot.com	https://kahoot.com/privacypolicy/
Gimkit	https://www.gimkit.com	https://www.gimkit.com/privacy
FBLA	https://www.fbla.org/	https://www.fblapbl.org/privacy-policy-2/

Name of Resource**	Website	Privacy Policy
Oyez	https://www.oyez.org	Free public/nonprofit resource — U.S. Supreme Court case summaries; no student account required
Cornell Legal Information Institute	https://www.law.cornell.edu	Free public/nonprofit legal reference resource; no student account required
CourtListener	https://www.courtlistener.com	Free public court-opinion database (Free Law Project); no student account required
U.S. SEC — Litigation & Enforcement	https://www.sec.gov/litigation	Official U.S. government resource; no student account required
U.S. EEOC — Youth Resources	https://www.eeoc.gov/youth	Official U.S. government resource; no student account required

*** The above resources are web-based resources or assessment platforms that require parent permission, or free public/government legal resources used to research case studies. Students completing an End of Pathway Assessment/Credentials of Value at the end of the school year will use similar platforms. By signing the syllabus, the parent is approving these resources. Should you have any questions regarding any of these classroom resources, please contact your student's teacher via email.*

PARENT/GUARDIAN ACKNOWLEDGMENT

I, _____, have read this course syllabus and approve of its contents. I understand that the syllabus may change in order and the projects may vary slightly throughout the year. I agree to allow my student to use each of the classroom resources listed in the learning resource section. I will support my student in following the classroom expectations outlined in this course syllabus. I agree that I am the person who is legally allowed to consent for my student, whose name is listed below.

Student Name (Print): _____

Parent/Guardian Name (Print): _____

Parent/Guardian Signature: _____

Date: _____